Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Country Specific Requirements France

Document Number: IQMS-99848
SSC-PTC-SOP-FR-015

Version: 4.0

Effective Date:	2026-01-31
QMS Area:	Quality
QMS Chapter:	4.9 Product Safety, Product Quality and Pharmacovigilance

Applicability

Bayer Level:	CH, PH

This document is electronically approved (signatures on the last page)

Distribution Sheet for Quality Regulations

Division/Business Unit ☒ PH ☒ CH

GBS Location
☐ Global Business Services Barcelona
☐ Global Business Services Costa Rica/Brazil
☐ Global Business Services Manila
☒ Global Business Services Gdansk
☐ Global Business Services India
☐ Global Business Services Dalian
☐ Global Business Services Germany

Region/ Country
☐ Global
☒ Specific Country: France

Relevance for R&D QMS
☐ Affected
☐ Interface
☒ N/A

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Training Role(s):	GBS_GDN_PTC_CLUSTER 3
Relevant Process and Activities:	PTC

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1 Scope and Framework

1.1 Scope

Bayer Country Quality Units are accountable for a GMP compliant Product Technical Complaint Management within their respective countries. Within this responsibility they are supported by the respective Global Business Service in process steps like complaint initiation, classification forwarding for investigation to the RQU, and final approval including complaint sample management and reimbursement process.

This SOP defines clear guidance to the Global Business Service regarding all country specific requirements.

1.2 Framework

This SOP is based on principles and requirements outlined in SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

2 Abbreviations

AE	Adverse Event
ANSM	Agence nationale de sécurité du médicament et des produits de santé (French Health Authorities)
CMO	Contract Manufacturing Organization
CQH	Country Quality Head
CQU	Country Quality Unit
GBS	Global Business Service
IUD	Intra Uterine Device
OTC products	Over-the-counter products
PAFP	Patient Affordability Focused Program
PSDMP	Patient Support diseases Management Program
PTC	Product Technical Complaint
PV	Pharmacovigilance
RQU	Responsible Quality Unit
SafeTrack (AE capture tool)	A GxP validated solution for PSDMP staff to capture at source and report in a digital, structured format product safety and quality-related information directly to Bayer Pharmacovigilance. Use is mandatory for newly initiated and ongoing PSDMP after SafeTrack has been fully implemented (in the local language) in a country.

3 Purpose & Set-Up

3.1 Purpose

Country Specific Requirements for France are described in this SOP, regarding e.g. Data Privacy, Sample Handling Process, Reimbursement Process, Contacts, escalation rules.

During the processing of all PTCs by Bayer owned Global Business Service all country specific requirements are considered and followed besides the general complaint handling described in the SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

3.2 General guidance

The employees of Global Business Services follow the SOP during complaint processing in the complaint database on behalf of the Country Quality Units.

3.3 Roles and responsibilities

GBS team

- Enters PTCs, Suspected Counterfeit Incidents and Usability Issues according to defined timelines in a timely manner, entering them into the global complaint database in English language
- Organizes missing information and asks CQU for any support contacting the complainant if not possible/allowed by GBS (e.g. data privacy, non-hosted language)
- Performs the initial intake of complaints after receipt
- Informs the CQU about all PTCs where local authorities are involved, about all potential counterfeits and any other cases described in this SOP
- Informs the respective PV about all PTCs with a potential associated AE or LODE or potentially reportable medical device complaints, including the unique complaint database number and all relevant follow-up information
- Forwards the case to the respective RQU for further assessment
- Initiates the process of sample shipment if requested by RQU or specified in any other guidance document
- Reviews the case for plausibility and closes the complaint case in complaint database, excluding exceptional cases:
    - Cases with final risk classification High or Medium (PTC and PTC+AE)
    - Cases involving local Health Authorities (excluding complaints containing only AE)
    - Confirmed Counterfeit Cases
- Sends out standard response letters in case it is agreed with the CQU
- Supports the process for reimbursement management
- Forwards all cases that are not PTCs to the CQU or to the appropriate function for further processing

Country Quality Head (CQH) / Country Quality Unit (CQU)

- Is responsible for regular KPI evaluation to get overview of complaint activities at the GBS
- Supports the GBS in organizing missing complaint information
- Organizes the complaint sample and sends it to the RQU if requested.
- Asks for any corrections to GBS or RQU during the processing of PTC and after closure (follow-up) if needed
- Approves the initial risk classification during a daily check for medicinal products

- Agrees with the conclusion of investigations:
  - During a daily check as part of the standard process
  - Directly in the complaint database during the closure step of the complaint for exceptional cases:
    - Cases with final risk classification High or Medium (PTC and PTC+AE)
    - Cases involving local Health Authorities (excluding complaints containing only AE)
    - Confirmed Counterfeit Cases

- Sends out the Response Letters to the complainants as requested and agreed with the GBS
- Contacts local CMO on request of GBS as RQU to get investigation reports from the respective CMO
- Ensures that all changes within the country law and regulation are directly notified to the GBS and that the Country Specific SOP is updated
- Ensures that the current list of distributed products is updated and contains all products.

4 Specific requirements regarding PTC handling

4.1 Country Specific Requirements listed by different topics

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
4.1.1 General Information In France the company operates under legal entity Bayer Healthcare SAS. Main office is located in Lille	
4.1.2 Contact list Country Quality Head: Elisabeth Vercambre Dewynter *elisabeth.vercambredewynter@bayer.com* General e-mail CQU Pharma: *assurancequalitebhc@bayer.com* General e-mail CQU Consumer Health: *qualite.ch@bayer.com* General e-mail CQU Radiology: *materiovigilance.radiologie@bayer.com* CQH deputy: Gregory Lionne *gregory.lionne@bayer.com* **Remark:** Current name and e-mail address of CQH and CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint: *https://bayergroup.sharepoint.com/sites/oneqint/SitePages/Who%20are%20we.aspx#country-quality-list*	
4.1.3 Escalation Rules The CQH and the CQH deputy should be notified via notification in the complaint database about any complaint case referring to at least one of the following situations: - Suspected Counterfeit Cases - Any cases involving Health Authorities CQH is in charge of informing the Responsible Pharmacist at a local level. **Remark:** CQU is notified of cases with final risk classification High or Medium or confirmed counterfeit cases when the case is assigned to CQU for approval, according to exceptions listed in chapter 4.1.13	GBS
4.1.4 Pharmacovigilance cases If a complaint case is related to any type of Adverse Event, the Pharmacovigilance department has to be informed via the following e-mail address: *frenchdrugsafety@bayer.com*. E-mails are also sent from *gpv.distribution@bayer.com* to GBS, as automated messages created by Bayer Pharmacovigilance database containing CIOMS (Council for International Organizations of Medical Sciences) report.	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
4.1.5 Product Samples As a general rule, the product sample is returned by the complainant in a package with a shipping label provided by CQU. If the package cannot be sent by post due to weight, CQU will send a request for a carrier to collect the package. **Consumer Health products patients/customers** are asked to bring the sample to pharmacy of their choice. If a complaint sample is declared available, ask the complainant using template e-mail (Annex 2) to bring the sample to the pharmacy whose address was provided by the patient in the response to the acknowledgment letter. **Pharma products patients** are not to be contacted by GBS. Generally, complainants are using phone contact to Bayer to place a complaint. Call center which handles phone calls advises patients to place a complaint through a healthcare professional, contact with HCP is not forbidden. Sample is obtained from HCP and HCP postal address is recovered using template acknowledgment letter e-mail (Annex 3). If a complaint comes from a Pharma patient, ask CQU for support to contact patient if needed. **IUD and Eylea Patient Affordability Focused Program (PAFP)** A third-party provider is in charge of PAFP for Eylea. If a sample is declared available, the third-party provider is sending a request for return. If sample has been already requested, a box “Envoi courrier de demande de retour du dispositif (date)” is going to be ticked and a date of the request provided. If an Eylea or IUD complaint comes directly from pharmacy and reimbursement is requested, the Business Unit has to be informed about the complaint, to start the PAFP process. To do that, add an additional sentence (for Eylea only) in the acknowledgment letter (Annex 3) and add Business Unit e-mail address in the e-mail copy. If the complaint on Eylea or IUD is coming directly from a physician, not the third-party provider, and reimbursement is requested, respond to the complaint using e-mail template Annex 5. Along with sending the template e-mail to physician, put *programme-remplacement-diu@universalmedica.com* (in case of IUD), *programme-remplacement-eylea@universalmedica.com* (in case of Eylea) in copy of the e-mail to start the replacement program. **Sales representatives** (Bayer employees) receiving a complaint can send the sample to CQU, if available and requested by GBS. **Essure samples** are recovered from hospitals after Essure removal, if declared available. To recover the sample, confirmation of receipt is sent to the hospital (Annex 9), in which there is an information about “return box” which will be sent by Bayer to the hospital. In the confirmation of receipt hospital internal reference number must be provided (e.g. MV-XX-XXXX). Customer Service addresses must be added to the copy of e-mail, pick-up and shipment is organized by Customer Service. **Patient Support diseases Management Program (PSDMP) for Kovaltry:** PTC and AE raised with PSDMP are handled through SafeTrack which can be used either	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

by patient or nurse (Patientys nurse). The nurse is taking the sample from a patient and brings it to CQU office. E-mail address *bayer-proxi@patientys.com* is a contact with the head office of Patientys nurses. Send an e-mail to the nurse using template e-mail (Annex 8) and provide the patient ID and date from SafeTrack report in order to recover the sample or batch number.

Betaferon injectors

CQU obtains defective device, after an exchange for a new one is done with the patient.

To recover the sample, send an e-mail to the pharmacy using template in Annex 4. If there is no e-mail address provided, forward the complaint to CQU. CQU contacts the pharmacy via phone, confirming that the sample is available and can be obtained.

Overseas territories

For complaints coming from overseas territories, no sample retrieval or replacement is performed. Reimbursement through a credit note is still possible.

Overseas territories	Prefecture/Chef-lieu
French Guiana	Cayenne
French Polynesia	Papeete
Guadeloupe	Basse-Terre
Martinique	Fort-de-France
Mayotte	Mamoudzou
New Caledonia	Nouméa
Réunion	Saint-Denis
Saint Barthélemy	Gustavia
Saint Martin	Marigot
Saint Pierre and Miquelon	Saint-Pierre
Wallis and Futuna	Mata-Utu

Products with local repackaging/relabeling

Some products are under repackaging/relabeling following a business request (e.g. 2 in 1 for better price). For these products a new SKU (material number) is often attributed. The repacking/relabeling operation is performed locally at third party. Depending on the complaint, the PTC could be an internal PTC and managed locally by CQU (e.g. all defects regarding folding boxes or re-packed containers will be internal complaints managed by CQU). In case of doubts, PTC Officer asks CQU for support.

Missing or damaged products

The call center will forward to GBS complaints coming from pharmacy, hospital or wholesaler regarding missing or damaged products in following cases:

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
a) missing products in orders: only cases of standard parcel (parcel containing 1 type of product) coming directly from Bayer warehouse and concerning 10 or more missing products in the parcel. Complaints regarding picking parcel or complaint on less than 10 products are handled by O2C and should be forwarded by the call center directly to them. b) damaged products in orders: - complaints about standard parcel with undamaged shipping box containing damaged items are assigned to the manufacturing site; - complaints about picking parcel with undamaged shipping box containing damaged items are assigned to CQU for local assessment; - complaints regarding damaged shipping box for both standard parcel and picking parcel are handled by O2C and should be forwarded by the call center directly to them.	
4.1.6 Statement letter **Acknowledgement Letter when a complaint comes in:** After a complaint is handed in, an immediate acknowledgement of receipt is sent out to the complainant. If there are missing data in the initial complaint (e.g. batch number), the acknowledgment letter will be expanded with the request for providing missing data by the complainant. - Standard templates are added in the Annex 3 (Acknowledgment letter). **Response Letter after closing:** For Pharma products response letter is sent for confirmed or plausible quality defect along with request for credit note/replacement or if unconfirmed but the complainant asked for a response (Annex 6). For Consumer Health products response letter is sent for confirmed or plausible quality defect and if the complainant asked for reimbursement actively or if the complainant asked for a response. (Annex 7). For Radiology disposable products, response letter is sent for confirmed or plausible quality defect along with request for credit note/replacement, but only if the complainant actively asked for reimbursement or replacement and after CQU approval; or if unconfirmed but the complainant asked for a response (Annex 6). **Exception:** In below cases CQU is responsible for response letter preparation: # Confirmed Final Risk Class High and Medium # Authority responses # Legal cases # Biogaran distributor cases	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
4.1.7 RQU Contact list A table with all available products in the country, needed for entry into the complaint database, is available on SharePoint: go/ptcops. For CH products registration status in the respective country as well as Manufacturing Site are available via SYNAPS: go/synaps. List with the respective RQU contact names are provided by the Divisional Quality Assurance function and available on the SharePoint: PH: *PH RQU responsible list_HJ.xlsx* CH: *IQMS_MASTER LIST COMPLAINT RESPONSIBILITIES.xlsx*	GBS
4.1.8 List of Local Opportunities Products n/a	
4.1.9 Data Privacy Requirements Documents that need to be attached directly to complaints cannot contain any patient private data and need to be anonymized before uploading. Other private data and documents containing it is stored in Confidential Persons section, which cannot be viewed by complaint database users not granted access to a given country. Please also note that in case of direct communication with a patient or health care professional, a disclaimer on the communication regarding data privacy has to be added.	
4.1.10 Gathering additional information (including obtaining translation) In case when the CQU receives a complaint first by ~~a~~ phone, then Product Complaint Form (see Annex 1) is used to document received information. The CQU sends this form to the GBS via e-mail as soon as possible, because timeline starts when phone complaint is received by the CQU. The written complaints will be placed in French language. French is not hosted language, and the complaints have to be translated by contacting Bayer Service Translation Office. If a situation occurs that there is only a phone number given in the complaint, and any information is missing (e.g. batch number), contact CQU and ask for support in calling the complainant. **Contact with Bayer employees in France** If GBS needs to communicate with Bayer internal staff, it can be done in English but a sentence in French must be added, indicating the possibility to respond to GBS in French, or to contact CQU in regard to the English language: ”Vous pouvez répondre en français ou en anglais à cet e-mail. Si vous avez besoin d’une aide sur la compréhension de l’e-mail, vous pouvez contacter le département Qualité de votre division.”	GBS CQU

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
4.1.11 Reimbursement and Replacement	GBS

Pharma

In case of confirmed quality defect or unconfirmed but plausible, PTC Officer informs Customer Service to issue a credit note on the invoice by sending template e-mail from Annex 6 to the complainant with information that a reimbursement is being granted. An additional e-mail (Annex 10) with reimbursement details has to be sent to Customer Service (*service.clients.pharmacie@bayer.com*). No replacement or reimbursement can be provided to the patient directly.

When complaint is sent for closure without conclusion (e.g. for Minor Defect), follow the guidelines prepared by CQU whether reimbursement can be granted.

For IUDs from **PAFP IUD program**, the local call center (third party, Universal Medica) is in charge to place an order to the warehouse (subcontractor Alloga) to replace the product, regardless of the RQU assessment.

For **Eylea PAFP program**, for all types of complaints and usability issues, the local call center (third party, Universal Medica) is in charge to place an order to the warehouse (subcontractor Alloga) to replace the product, regardless of the RQU assessment.

For unconfirmed quality defects, if the complainant insists on receiving reimbursement, PTC officer send e-mail to CQU, they are sending the request to responsible Business Unit.

Betaferon Injector

In case of breakdown, the patient is asked by the Medical Information call center to drop off the auto-injector at the pharmacy of patient's choice. New device arrives at the pharmacy 3-4 days after the complaint is forwarded by the Medical Information call center to the respective marketing service. The information about the complaint being forwarded to the marketing service is indicated in the complaint report. If in the complaint report it is not stated that the complaint was forwarded to the marketing service, it needs to be forwarded by GBS, to ensure the pharmacy is going to be contacted by the marketing service and the replacement procedure initiated. This replacement is not connected to result of the RQU investigation.

Consumer Health

In case of confirmed quality defect or unconfirmed but plausible, PTC Officer informs Customer Service using text in Annex 10 to issue a credit note on the invoice, but only if the complainant actively asked for reimbursement or replacement. To inform the CH patient that replacement is being granted send an e-mail using text in Annex 7.

When complaint is sent for closure without conclusion (e.g. for Low Risk Product or Minor Defect), follow the guidelines prepared by CQU whether reimbursement can be granted.

Radiology

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
In case of confirmed quality defect or unconfirmed but plausible, PTC Officer informs Customer Service using text in Annex 10 to issue a credit note on the invoice, but only if the complainant actively asked for reimbursement or replacement and after CQU approval. **Consumer Health and Radiology** For unconfirmed quality defects, if the complainant insists on receiving reimbursement, PTC officer send e-mail to CQU, they are sending the request to responsible Business Unit.	
4.1.12 Mandatory Spot Checks for Translations For all countries where the complaints are sent out for translation to the translation tool, once a year mandatory spot checks must be performed. 5% of all complaints numbers per year should be checked by native speaker (based on random selection), e.g. CQU. Important is to check the “original income text” with “translated text” provided by translation provider. The GBS is the owner of the process and start this action. The GBS leads the process, picks the cases and provides report to the CQU. The CQU checks the translation and indicates the deviations. Acceptance Criteria: • No Major translation deviations • Total number of Minor translation deviations is less than 5%. . Deviations in the translation can be described as Minor or Major. • Minor translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section of a sentence has been insufficiently translated, but the essence or meaning of the original message is still captured. • Major translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section has been incorrectly translated (for example by the introduction of a new word or exclusion of a word from the original complaint in the translated version) which results in an incorrect essence or meaning in the translation of the original message. In case of a major translation deviation and exceeding 5% minor cases, the GBS will be informed promptly to open a deviation in the complaint database and to ensure appropriate CAPAs. In addition, the translation office needs to be informed.	GBS
4.1.13 Exceptions and special cases **Complaints from Monaco and Overseas Territories** Complaints received from Monaco and French Overseas Territories, and Confidential Persons created for those complaints, are entered in the complaint database with country selected as France.	

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

Closing cases by CQU

In order to fulfill the Exploitant's responsibilities, the following cases need to be assigned to CQU for closure:

- any complaint with final risk class High or Medium;
- complaints involving local Health Authorities (excluding complaints containing only AE – only cases including PTC need to be assigned);
- confirmed counterfeit cases.

The PTC officer assigns the respective CQU employee as approver of the complaint, who performs the plausibility check and closes the case.

CQU daily check of cases involving medicinal products

CQU performs a daily check of every medicinal product related PTC entered/closed the working day before. CQU may request for a correction to be made by GBS; PTC officer evaluates in agreement with CQU if this correction would be valid under current guidelines. If the correction is implemented, the request is documented in the case's communication protocol; the CQU performs the closure of the corrected case in complaint database. If a correction of the RQU conclusion is necessary, then CQU is responsible for creating the follow-up case and then closing it. In case of a product type modification to drug product or combination product in the complaint database for a complaint that has already been entered, GBS informs CQU of the change so that the modified complaint can be added to the daily check.

Essure

In case of Essure complaints, follow below rules for complaint entry:

- field "Description":
  - In case of multiple adverse effects (AE): "Several AEs (see attachment for details)"
  - If implant removal performed: "implants were removed"
  - If implant removal scheduled: "removal of implants planned"
  - If removal of implant under study: "potential removal of implants"
  - For any case mentioning the removal of Essure implant (performed, scheduled or under study), add systematically the mention "potential lawsuit" in this field (this is done to inform RQU that sample must be kept as long as deemed necessary by legal counsel)

- fields "Customer Response Required?" and "Specific Response Required":
  - Case form HA: Yes + « ANSM – MEDDEV »
  - Case from HCP/Hospital: Yes + « A response will be sent to complainant based on the results of the final assessment »
  - Case from a patient, lawyer or media: No + « Response only sent to Health Professionals »
  - Local QA never provides any answer, whoever the complainant is. We assume that answer is provided by PV to HA and HCP

If the Essure case comes from Health Authorities and the complainant is a patient, there are no contact details provided so no sample can be retrieved.

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

If the Essure case is forwarded by PQS and is coming from a hospital following implants removal, the samples may be available even if it is not mentioned in CIOMS report or cover letter. If contact details are provided and sample is declared available, the hospital must be contacted to confirm the samples' availability, by sending confirmation of receipt (Annex 9). Customer service has to be added as a recipient in the copy of the e-mail. A return box is then sent to the hospital by local Customers Service, and the box is sent directly to RQU in Costa Rica. If contact details are provided and the sample status is not known, ask the hospital for sample availability using text from Annex 9.

If the Essure case is coming from Health Authorities and the complainant is a hospital, but the complaint is forwarded by local PV (not on CIOMS report), ask local PV for source document if not already provided, and follow the same rule for sample retrieval as above.

If the Essure case is received from PV PQS on CIOMs report and the report source is marked as literature case, GBS is not responsible for entry in complaint database. Forward literature cases to RQU (essureptc-costarica@bayer.com) and give in copy the address of the sender- PV PQS.

Medical devices with local sourcing

Complaints for medical devices with local sourcing (hysterometers) should be forwarded to CQU, which acts as RQU for those products.

Coffrets (Gadovist and Ultravist)

In French market combination products, called coffrets are available. Coffrets consist of a vial of a contrast media and a consumable for a medical device (syringe, tubing).

Biogaran distributor

The product Minerva-35 is not distributed by Bayer France, but by Biogaran company. In case of complaints, GBS does not contact the complainant, only Biogaran does. Generally, all the information available on the complaint is provided in the complaint e-mail from Biogaran. Response is required and will be sent by the country quality team; before the case is closed, GBS forwards the complaint number to CQU and attaches the provided response to the complaint.

4.1.14 Others

Reference numbers

Reference numbers of complaints coming from sources listed below, should be added to in complaint intake for traceability purposes.

- Eylea/IUD PAFP
- Health Authorities complaints
- SafeTrack report
- Medical Information MIIDAS report reference
- complainant reference if mentioned in the report

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
PTC received on MIIDAS report from Medical Information In case a PTC is received on MIIDAS report, the corresponding complaint ID should be sent to local Medical Information department (*infomed.france@bayer.com*) for traceability purposes. If MI department does not receive the complaint ID, a reminder will be sent to GBS with CQU in CC to ensure communication between both parties.	

5 Internal References

- SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaints and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”

6 External References

- N/A

History of changes

Version	Significant changes with respect to previous version	Effective date
1	New document	2021-06-28
2	# Whole document: updated abbreviation SSC/SSCDN with GBS and “Shared Service Center” with “Global Business Services” # Chapter 2 ANSM added to abbreviations list # Chapter 3.3 GBS and CQH/CQU roles updated: correction requests, daily check, involvement in Dev@Com for exceptional cases # Chapter 4.1.2 Added CQU Radiology e-mail # Chapter 4.1.3 Escalation rules updated # Chapter 4.1.5 Updated general sample retrieval information; updated third party provider/call center information; updated CRS program handling information; removed Business Unit specific e-mail addresses; corrected typos in “Patientys”; added information on overseas territories # Chapter 4.1.6 Updated CH response letter information, added Biogaran distributor to exceptions # Chapter 4.1.9 Added information on data privacy statement to health care professionals # Chapter 4.1.11 Removed marketing service e-mail address for Betaferon injectors; Consumer Health reimbursement clarified; added information that Radiology reimbursement is to be approved by CQU # Chapter 4.1.13 Added information on complaints to be closed by CQU; added information on CQU daily check of medicinal products cases; fixed e-mail address error for Essure literature cases; updated information about response for Biogaran products # Chapter 4.1.14 Updated from IRMS to MIIDAS # Annex 2 updated # Annex 3 updated # Annex 4 updated # Annex 5 updated # Annex 6 updated # Annex 7 updated # Annex 8 updated # Annex 9 updated	2022-11-23
3	# Applicability sheet replaced by Distribution Sheet # Whole document: minor grammatical and spelling errors corrected # Chapter 1 updated “Shared Service Center” with “Global Business Services” and “SSCDN” with “GBS” # Chapter 2 abbreviations added/updated # Chapter 3.1 updated “SSCDN” with “GBS” # Chapter 3.3 updated information for exceptional cases closed by CQU, removed unnecessary text in CQU roles # Chapter 4.1.1. CQU office location updated # Chapter 4.1.2 updated CQH name and e-mail address; updated QINT SharePoint address # Chapter 4.1.3 remark updated	2024-11-26

	# Chapter 4.1.4 PV e-mail address updated # Chapter 4.1.5 updated general sample retrieval rule; updated IUD/Eylea and Kovaltry patient program names; updated Essure samples information; updated information about complaints for damaged products in orders; added clarification that credit note for overseas territories can be created # Chapter 4.1.7 information added about SYNAPS used for checking product registration status and manufacturing sites. Reference to global lists with RQU names for PH and CH. # Chapter 4.1.11 added information about using Annex 10 for contacting Customer Service about reimbursement, updated IUD/Eylea program name # Chapter 4.1.13 closing cases by CQU – local Health Authorities specified; needles removed from devices with local sourcing; Cyproterone removed from Biogaran distributor list (no longer marketed) # Chapter 4.1.14 updated IUD/Eylea program name # Chapter 5 updated “SSCDN” with “GBS # Annex 2 updated according to current process # Annex 3 wording updated # Annex 5 updated CRS with PAFP # Annexes 6 and 7 information about adding Customer Service address in cc removed, Annex 7 wording updated # Annex 8 updated with new address # Annex 10 added - Reimbursement request sent to Customer Service	
4	# Updated according to SSC-PTC-BP-002 v.6.0 Country Specific SOP template # Roles and responsibilities updated based on SSC-PTC-SOP-001 v.6.0 # All references to “Dev@com” updated to “complaint database”, and all risk classification mentions updated, due to change of the complaint database system # Small grammar corrections throughout the entire document # Chapter 2 Abbreviations updated # Chapter 4.1.2 Reference to QINT SharePoint updated # Chapter 4.1.3 Escalation rules updated to follow the process in current complaint database # Chapter 4.1.6 Added information about response for Radiology complaints # Chapter 4.1.7 RQU contact list links updated # Chapter 4.1.9. Data privacy rules updated # Chapter 4.1.10 Removed no longer relevant information about cases with risk class I and II received by CQU # Chapter 4.1.11 Added information on reimbursement of complaints sent for closure without conclusion # Chapter 4.1.13 Added clarification on complaints from Monaco and Overseas Territories; Closing cases by CQU updated to reflect current complaint database process; updated Essure cases description; updated Biogaran products details	See Cover page

	# Chapter 4.1.14 Updated reference numbers & Medical Information guidelines updated # Annex 3 updated – missing word included, added clarification # Annex 6 clarification that it can be used also for Radiology # Annex 7 updated with templates for when complaint is not investigated # Annex 10 updated	

Annex 1

Product Complaint Form

Complaint created (date)……
Complaint received (date) ……

Product information:	
Product name	
Batch / lot number	
Dosage form *(cream, tablet, capsule, etc.)*	
Package type/size	
Number of packages	
Sample available?*	Yes/No
*Sample available = please keep for further potential shipment	

Complaint information:	
Complaint description (defect description, is it suspected counterfeit case, etc.)	
Adverse event reported?	Yes/No
Does the complainant expect a response from Bayer?**	
**By requesting a response, the Complainant agrees to his/hers contact data being processed by Bayer for the purpose of providing the answer to the submitted complaint *(the exact sounding to be aligned with legal)*	

Complainants' contact information attention: in the countries with special Data Privacy regulations to be replaced by the complainant code number (to be given by CQU)	
Name and surname	
E-mail address	
Telephone	
Home address	

Sender (if other than Complainant, e.g. a pharmacy)	
Senders' Name (Legal entity)	
Address	
E-Mail address	
Telephone number	

Any additional information	

Templates

Annex 2

CH Patient sample recovery



CH sample recovery (patient).docx

Annex 3

Acknowledgment letters



Acknowledgement letter.docx

Annex 4

Acknowledgment letter for complaints on Betaferon Injectors



AL Betaferon injectors.docx

Annex 5

Acknowledgment letter to a complaint on IUD/Eylea from physician



AL PAFP IUD Eylea from physician.docx

Annex 6

Pharma & Radiology response letter (reimbursement/replacement)



PH Response.docx

Annex 7

Consumer Health response letter



CH response letter.docx

Annex 8

Kovaltry sample recovery (patients)



Kovaltry sample recovery (patient).doc

Annex 9

Essure sample recovery



Essure sample recovery.docx

Annex 10

Reimbursement request sent to Customer Service



Reimbursement request sent to CS.do

Task: Content Approval Verdict: Approve changes & release Approval to be made Effective	Elisabeth Vercambre Dewynter (elisabeth.vercambredewynter@bayer.com) Approver - Content 14-Jan-2026 07:13:03 GMT+0000
Task: Final Approval Verdict: Approve changes & release Final Approval to be made Effective	katarzyna mazur kominek (katarzyna.mazur-kominek@bayer.com) Approver 16-Jan-2026 08:31:55 GMT+0000